

Research has shown that when individuals consume the same food stimulus, they reach satiety faster compared to when they consume varied food stimuli. This finding suggests that satiety, which involves a reduction in both physiological and behavioral responses to food stimuli, may be partly due to:

- ☐ A. desensitization. [28%]
- ✔ ☒ B. habituation. [61%]
- ☐ C. operant conditioning. [5%]
- ☐ D. generalization. [4%]

Correct

61% answered correctly

Explanation:

Nonassociative learning	
Habituation	Decreased response to a stimulus over time (eg, no longer noticing that a sweater feels scratchy after wearing it for a few minutes)
Dishabituation	A renewed response to a previously habituated stimulus (eg, after taking off the sweater & then putting it back on, it feels scratchy again)
Sensitization	Increased response to a stimulus over time (eg, sweater's scratchiness becomes more irritating until it is unbearable)
Desensitization	Decreased response to a previously sensitized stimulus over time (eg, irritation from previously unbearable scratchiness diminishes over time)

Habituation, a type of nonassociative learning, occurs when **repeated exposure** to a stimulus results in a **decreased response**. For example, an individual who has had an intravenous line (stimulus) inserted into the arm might initially notice the feeling of it but will notice it less over time (diminished response).

Appetite and satiety are influenced by internal and external cues. The research finding that when individuals consume the same food stimulus (ie,

repeated exposure to a stimulus) they reach satiety (ie, *diminished physiological and behavioral response*) faster than when they consume varied food stimuli suggests that satiety may be partly due to *habituation*.

(Choice A) Sensitization, another type of nonassociative learning, occurs when a stimulus produces an increasing response, and desensitization occurs when a response to a sensitized stimulus is reduced. The research findings did not show an increased response followed by a decreased response, so desensitization is not involved.

(Choice C) Operant conditioning, a type of associative learning, occurs when the likelihood of repeating a behavior is influenced by reinforcement (increases likelihood) or punishment (decreases likelihood). The research findings did not show reinforcement or punishment influencing the future likelihood of a behavior, so operant conditioning is not involved.

(Choice D) Generalization occurs in classical conditioning (a type of associative learning) when a conditioned response is elicited by stimuli similar to the original conditioned stimulus (eg, a baby conditioned to fear a white stuffed toy also fears white hair). The research findings did not show a conditioned response elicited by stimuli similar to the original conditioned stimulus, so generalization is not involved.

Educational objective:

Habituation is a type of nonassociative learning that occurs when repeated exposure to a stimulus results in a decreased response.

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